Grafana — 3–4 YOE Scenario-Based Q&A

1. Grafana dashboard is showing no data. What will you check?
Ans: First, I check whether the Grafana datasource is connected and working correctly. Then I verify whether Prometheus is returning metrics for the selected time range.
I also check the dashboard query, metric name, labels, and time range. If the query is correct, I check whether the required metrics are actually available in Prometheus.
Simple ga gurthupettuko: Dashboard lo data raakapothe → first datasource check cheyyi → Prometheus metrics vastunnaya chudu → query and metric name verify cheyyi → labels and time range check cheyyi → Prometheus lo metric available unda confirm cheyyi → issue fix chesi dashboard verify cheyyi.
Eng: If the Grafana dashboard shows no data → first check the datasource → verify Prometheus is returning metrics → check the query and metric name → verify labels and time range → confirm the metric exists in Prometheus → fix the issue and verify the dashboard.
Example:
Grafana → Dashboard → Data Source → Prometheus → connection correct ga unda check cheyyi.
Explore → Prometheus → up → metric data vastunda check cheyyi.
Dashboard panel → Edit → Query → correct metric and labels use chesthunnara chudu.
Time range → Last 15 minutes → required time range select chesi data vastunda verify cheyyi.
Issue fix chesi → dashboard refresh chesi → data correct ga display avutunda verify cheyyi.

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2. Grafana is unable to connect to Prometheus. What will you check?
Ans: First, I check the Grafana datasource configuration and verify the Prometheus URL. Then I check whether the Prometheus server is running and reachable from the Grafana server.
I also verify network connectivity, port configuration, and any firewall or security restrictions. After correcting the datasource or connectivity issue, I test the connection again.
Simple ga gurthupettuko: Grafana Prometheus ki connect avvakapothe → first datasource configuration chudu → Prometheus URL verify cheyyi → Prometheus running unda check cheyyi → Grafana nunchi Prometheus reach avutunda chudu → port and firewall check cheyyi → issue fix chesi connection test cheyyi.
Eng: If Grafana cannot connect to Prometheus → first check the datasource configuration → verify the Prometheus URL → check whether Prometheus is running → verify connectivity from Grafana → check the port and firewall → fix the issue and test the connection.
Example:
Grafana → Connections → Data Sources → Prometheus → Prometheus URL correct ga unda check cheyyi.
curl http://prometheus:9090/-/healthy → Prometheus reachable and healthy ga unda chudu.
ss -lntp | grep 9090 → Prometheus port listen avutunda check cheyyi.
Grafana → Save & Test → datasource connection successful avutunda verify cheyyi.
Issue fix chesi → Save & Test → connection successful ani verify cheyyi.

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3. Grafana panel query is not returning expected data. What will you check?
Ans: First, I check the PromQL query used by the panel and verify whether the metric name and labels are correct. Then I run the same query directly in Prometheus to confirm whether it returns data.
I also check the selected time range and filters used in the dashboard. If the query works in Prometheus but not in Grafana, I verify the datasource and panel configuration.
Simple ga gurthupettuko: Panel query data ivvakapothe → first PromQL query chudu → metric name and labels verify cheyyi → same query Prometheus lo run cheyyi → time range and filters check cheyyi → Grafana datasource and panel configuration verify cheyyi → issue fix chesi panel data verify cheyyi.
Eng: If the Grafana panel query returns no expected data → first check the PromQL query → verify the metric and labels → run the same query in Prometheus → check the time range and filters → verify Grafana datasource and panel configuration → fix the issue and verify the panel.
Example:
Grafana → Panel → Edit → Query → PromQL query correct ga unda chudu.
Prometheus → Query → same PromQL query run chesi data vastunda check cheyyi.
up{job="node-exporter"} → correct metric and label use chesthunnara verify cheyyi.
Dashboard → Time Range → required time range select chesi data vastunda chudu.
Issue fix chesi → panel refresh chesi → expected metrics display avutunnaya verify cheyyi.

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4. Grafana alert is not firing. What will you check?
Ans: First, I check the alert rule and verify whether the query is returning the expected metric value. Then I check the alert condition, threshold, evaluation interval, and pending period.
I also verify whether the alert rule is enabled and whether the notification contact point is configured correctly. Finally, I check the alert state and Grafana logs if required.
Simple ga gurthupettuko: Alert fire avvakapothe → first alert rule chudu → query data verify cheyyi → condition and threshold check cheyyi → evaluation and pending time verify cheyyi → alert enabled unda chudu → contact point check cheyyi → alert state and logs verify cheyyi.
Eng: If the Grafana alert is not firing → first check the alert rule → verify query data → check the condition and threshold → verify evaluation and pending time → confirm the alert is enabled → check the contact point → review the alert state and logs.
Example:
Grafana → Alerting → Alert Rules → alert rule enabled ga unda check cheyyi.
Query → required metric value vastunda verify cheyyi.
Condition: CPU > 80 → threshold correct ga unda chudu.
Evaluation interval → alert regular ga evaluate avutunda check cheyyi.

Contact Points → notification destination correct ga unda verify cheyyi.
Issue fix chesi → alert condition trigger chesi → alert firing state ki vachinda verify cheyyi.

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5. Grafana dashboard is loading very slowly. What will you check?
Ans: First, I check which dashboard panels are taking more time to load. Then I review the PromQL queries and identify queries that return too many time series or process a large amount of data.
I also check the dashboard time range, refresh interval, panel count, and Prometheus response time. After identifying the slow query or configuration, I optimize it and verify the dashboard performance.
Simple ga gurthupettuko: Dashboard slow ga load ayithe → first slow panel identify cheyyi → PromQL queries check cheyyi → too much data or time series vastunnaya chudu → time range and refresh interval verify cheyyi → Prometheus response time check cheyyi → query optimize chesi dashboard speed verify cheyyi.
Eng: If the Grafana dashboard is slow → first identify the slow panel → check the PromQL queries → verify whether too much data or too many time series are returned → check the time range and refresh interval → check Prometheus response time → optimize the query and verify performance.
Example:
Dashboard → Panel → Query → ye panel slow ga respond avutundo identify cheyyi.
Prometheus → Query → same query execution response slow ga unda chudu.
Time Range → Last 7 days → unnecessary large time range use chesthunnara check cheyyi.
Refresh → 5s → refresh interval too frequent ga unda verify cheyyi.
Issue fix chesi → dashboard reload chesi → panels fast ga load avutunnaya verify cheyyi.

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6. Grafana variables are not working correctly. What will you check?
Ans: First, I check the dashboard variable configuration and verify the query used to populate the variable. Then I confirm that the required metric and label are available in Prometheus.
I also check whether the variable is correctly referenced inside the panel queries and whether the selected value is being passed correctly. After correcting the variable configuration, I refresh the dashboard and verify the results.
Simple ga gurthupettuko: Grafana variable work avvakapothe → first variable configuration chudu → variable query verify cheyyi → required metric and label Prometheus lo unnaya check cheyyi → panel query lo variable correct ga use chesthunnara chudu → selected value pass avutunda verify cheyyi → issue fix chesi dashboard refresh cheyyi.
Eng: If a Grafana variable is not working → first check the variable configuration → verify the variable query → confirm the metric and label exist in Prometheus → check the variable reference in the panel query → verify the selected value is passed correctly → fix the issue and refresh the dashboard.
Example:
Dashboard Settings → Variables → variable configuration open chesi query check cheyyi.
label_values(up, instance) → instances list vastunda verify cheyyi.
Panel Query → instance="$instance" → variable panel query lo correct ga use chesthunnara chudu.
Dashboard → Variable dropdown → expected values display avutunnaya check cheyyi.
Issue fix chesi → variable select chesi → panel data corresponding ga change avutunda verify cheyyi.

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7. Grafana dashboard is showing incorrect metrics. What will you check?
Ans: First, I check the panel query and verify the metric name, labels, aggregation, and filters. Then I compare the query result with the expected values in Prometheus.
I also check whether the dashboard is using the correct datasource and whether the selected environment, instance, or service is correct. After identifying the query or configuration issue, I correct it and verify the displayed metric.
Simple ga gurthupettuko: Wrong metrics kanipisthe → first panel query chudu → metric name and labels verify cheyyi → aggregation and filters check cheyyi → Prometheus result tho compare cheyyi → correct datasource and environment verify cheyyi → query fix chesi metric malli verify cheyyi.
Eng: If Grafana shows incorrect metrics → first check the panel query → verify the metric name and labels → check aggregation and filters → compare the result with Prometheus → verify the datasource and environment → fix the query and verify the metric again.
Example:
Panel → Edit → Query → metric name and labels correct ga unnaya chudu.
Prometheus → Query → same query result tho compare cheyyi.
Data Source → correct Prometheus datasource select ayyinda verify cheyyi.
Environment / Instance variable → correct server or environment select ayyinda check cheyyi.
Issue fix chesi → panel refresh chesi → expected metric value display avutunda verify cheyyi.

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8. Grafana datasource is working, but some metrics are missing. What will you check?
Ans: First, I verify whether the missing metric exists in Prometheus. Then I check whether Prometheus is successfully scraping the target that should provide that metric.
I also verify the exporter, target labels, scrape configuration, and metric name. If the target is down or the exporter is not exposing the metric, I fix that issue and verify the metric again in Grafana.
Simple ga gurthupettuko: Metrics missing ayithe → first Prometheus lo metric unda chudu → target scrape avutunda check cheyyi → target status verify cheyyi → exporter running unda chudu → scrape configuration and metric name verify cheyyi → issue fix chesi Grafana lo metric verify cheyyi.
Eng: If some metrics are missing → first check whether the metric exists in Prometheus → verify the target is being scraped → check target status → verify the exporter → check scrape configuration and metric name → fix the issue and verify the metric in Grafana.
Example:
Prometheus → Graph → metric_name → missing metric available unda chudu.
Prometheus → Status → Targets → target UP ga unda check cheyyi.
curl http://target:9100/metrics → exporter metrics expose chesthunda verify cheyyi.
prometheus.yml → target and scrape configuration correct ga unnaya chudu.

Issue fix chesi → Prometheus metric verify cheyyi → Grafana dashboard lo same metric display avutunda check cheyyi.

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9. Grafana is showing data from the wrong environment. What will you check?
Ans: First, I check which Prometheus datasource the dashboard is using. Then I verify the dashboard variables, labels, and selected environment value.
I also check whether the Prometheus datasource itself is connected to the correct environment. After correcting the datasource or variable configuration, I verify that the dashboard displays the expected environment data.
Simple ga gurthupettuko: Wrong environment data vasthe → first datasource chudu → correct Prometheus aa check cheyyi → environment variable verify cheyyi → labels and filters check cheyyi → Prometheus correct environment ki connect ayyinda verify cheyyi → configuration fix chesi dashboard data verify cheyyi.
Eng: If Grafana shows data from the wrong environment → first check the datasource → verify the correct Prometheus → check the environment variable → verify labels and filters → confirm Prometheus points to the correct environment → fix the configuration and verify the dashboard.
Example:
Dashboard → Settings → Data Source → correct environment Prometheus select ayyinda chudu.
Dashboard → Environment variable → prod select ayyinda verify cheyyi.
Prometheus → Targets → production targets matrame expected ga unnaya check cheyyi.
Panel Query → environment label filter correct ga unda verify cheyyi.
Issue fix chesi → dashboard refresh chesi → correct environment data display avutunda verify cheyyi.

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10. Grafana is showing "No Data" for a previously working dashboard. What will you check?
Ans: First, I check whether the Prometheus datasource is available and whether Prometheus is receiving new metrics. Then I check the dashboard time range because an incorrect time range can make a working dashboard appear empty.
I also verify the panel queries and whether the metric names or labels have changed. If there was a recent deployment or monitoring configuration change, I check that as well.
Simple ga gurthupettuko: Previously work ayina dashboard No Data chupisthe → first datasource and Prometheus check cheyyi → new metrics vastunnaya chudu → time range verify cheyyi → panel queries and labels check cheyyi → recent monitoring changes chudu → issue fix chesi dashboard verify cheyyi.
Eng: If a previously working dashboard shows No Data → first check the datasource and Prometheus → verify new metrics are arriving → check the time range → verify panel queries and labels → review recent monitoring changes → fix the issue and verify the dashboard.
Example:
Grafana → Data Source → Save & Test → datasource working unda check cheyyi.
Prometheus → Status → Targets → targets UP ga unnaya chudu.
Dashboard → Time Range → Last 15 minutes → recent data select chesi check cheyyi.
Panel → Edit → Query → metric and labels still correct ga unnaya verify cheyyi.
Issue fix chesi → dashboard refresh chesi → data malli display avutunda verify cheyyi.